Installing Chessboard on Windows 11

This guide takes you from the downloaded Chessboard folder to a working program.

Before you start, you need:

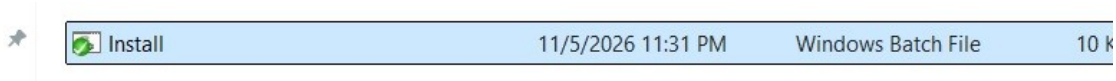
- the Chessboard folder on your computer
- a Windows 11 computer
- an internet connection

Chessboard needs Python 3.15, and the setup checks whether you already have it. If you don't, the setup helps you install it.

> If you want to keep the Chessboard folder somewhere else, such as in Documents, move it now, before you start the setup.

Step 1: Start the setup

1. Open the Chessboard folder in File Explorer.
2. Double-click **Install.bat**. Windows may hide the end of the name and show just **Install**. Its type is "Windows Batch File".



The Install file in File Explorer

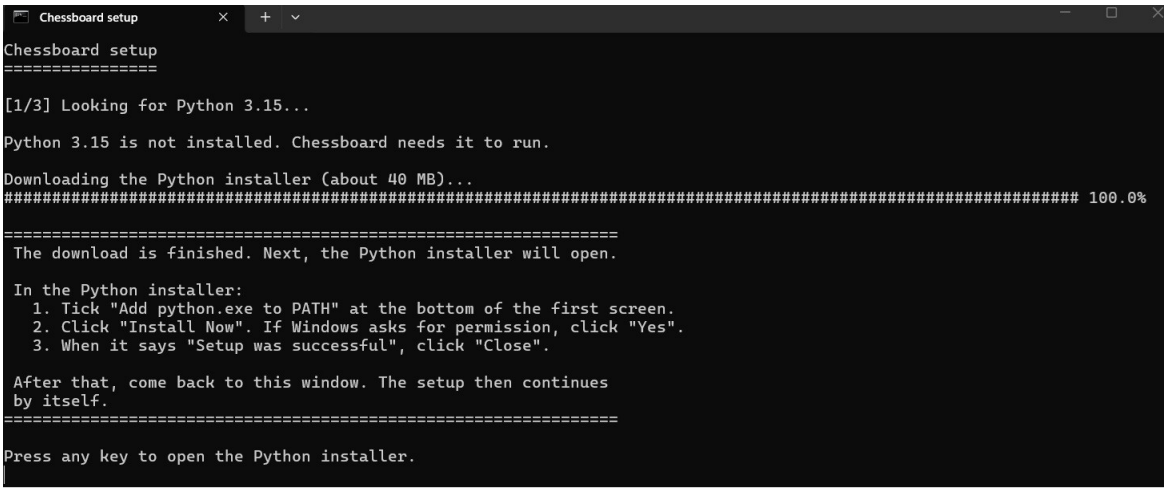
3. Windows may show a blue box saying "Windows protected your PC". This is normal for files downloaded from the internet. Click **More info**, then **Run anyway**. If a box asks "Do you want to run this file?" instead, click **Run**.

A black window called "Chessboard setup" opens. It shows the progress in three parts, [1/3] to [3/3].

- **If Python 3.15 is already installed**, the window says "Found." after [1/3]. Go straight to Step 3.
- **If Python 3.15 is missing**, the window says "Python 3.15 is not installed" and downloads the Python installer. Continue with Step 2.

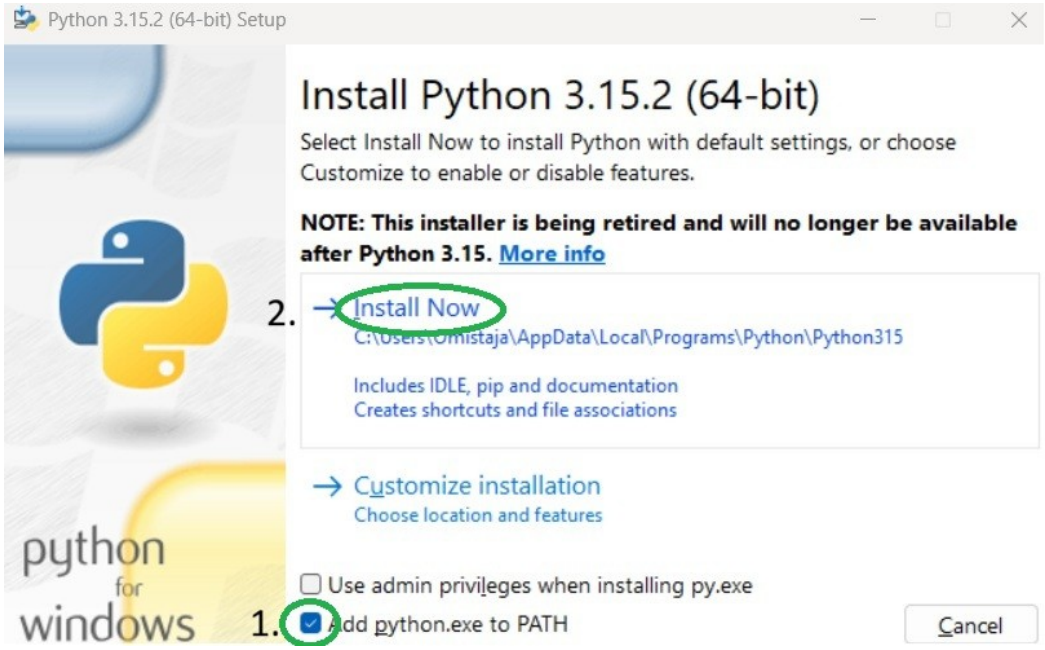
Step 2: Install Python (only if it is missing)

1. Wait for the download to reach 100%. The window then explains what is coming next. Press any key on the keyboard to open the Python installer.



The setup window after it has downloaded the Python installer

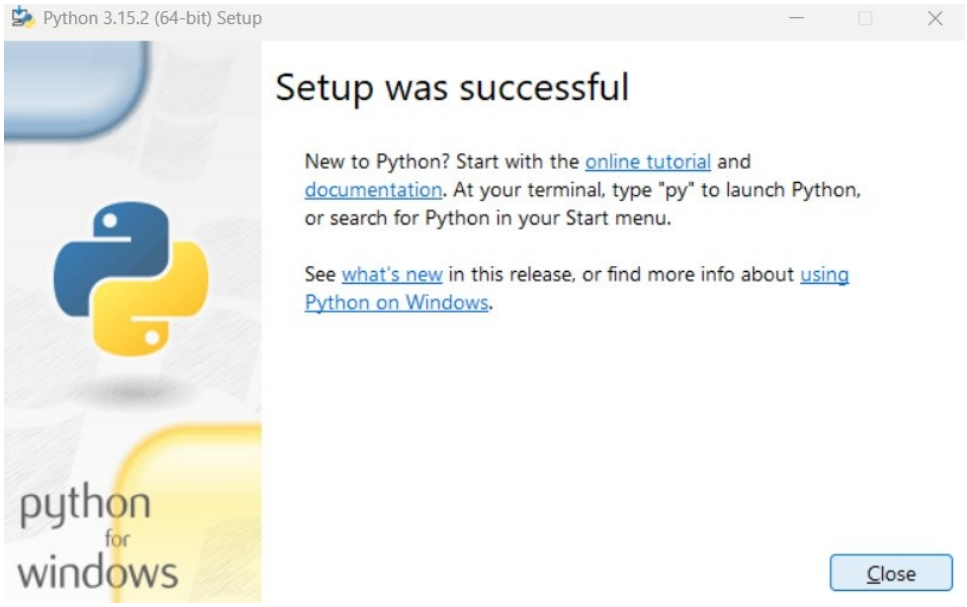
2. In the Python installer, do these two things in this order:
    1. At the bottom of the window, tick **Add python.exe to PATH**.
    2. Click **Install Now**. If Windows asks for permission, click **Yes**.



The first screen of the Python installer. Tick the box first (1), then click Install Now (2).

You can ignore the note in the installer that says it is being retired. Leave the other tick box as it is.

3. Wait for the installation to finish. When the installer says “Setup was successful”, click **Close**.



The Python installer has finished. Click Close.

The black setup window now says “Python is installed. Continuing the setup…” and carries on by itself.

Step 3: Let the setup finish

The setup now installs the remaining parts without any help from you:

- **[2/3]** installs the libraries Chessboard needs.

- **[3/3]** downloads Stockfish, the chess engine that plays against you. This is about 80 MB and can take a few minutes, and a progress bar may be shown. The picture below was taken on a computer that already had Stockfish, so it does not show the download.

Just wait until you see **Everything is ready**, then press any key. The window closes.

```
Python is installed. Continuing the setup...

[1/3] Looking for Python 3.15...
      Found.

[2/3] Installing the libraries Chessboard needs...
      Done.

[3/3] Setting up Stockfish (the chess engine)...
      Done: engines\stockfish\stockfish.exe

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 Everything is ready.
 Start the program by double-clicking Chessboard.bat
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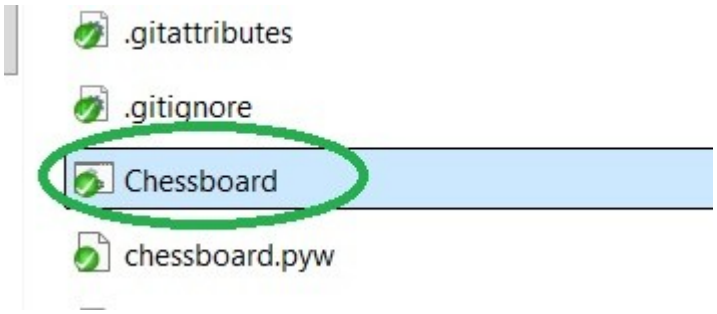
Press any key to continue . . .
```

The setup has finished

If you see any other message instead, read what it says and see “If something goes wrong” at the end of this guide.

Step 4: Start Chessboard

1. In the Chessboard folder, double-click **Chessboard.bat**. Windows may show it as just **Chessboard**. Use this same file every time you want to play.



The Chessboard file in File Explorer. The small green mark on the icon may not appear on your computer.

   Do not open the similarly named file **chessboard.pyw**. If Windows shows the blue box again, click **More info**, then **Run anyway**.

2. The chessboard opens. Check that Stockfish works: open the **Game** menu and choose **Play vs Computer…**. You should be able to choose Stockfish as the opponent.

> **Tip:** To get an icon on your desktop, right-click **Chessboard.bat**, then choose **Show more options**, **Send to** and **Desktop (create shortcut)**.

The installation is now complete.

If something goes wrong

You can run **Install.bat** as many times as you like. It only does what is still missing.

“The program files were not found next to this file”

You are probably still inside the zip file. Right-click the zip file, choose **Extract All...**, open the new folder and double-click **Install.bat** there.

“The installer could not be downloaded here”

Your web browser downloads the Python installer instead. When it has finished, open **python-3.15.2-amd64.exe** from your Downloads folder and follow Step 2. Then double-click **Install.bat** again to finish the setup.

“Python 3.15 was not found yet”

If the Python installer is still open, finish it first and press any key in the black window. If you closed the installer too early, close the black window and double-click **Install.bat** again. If you changed the installation folder, restart the computer and double-click **Install.bat** again.

You forgot to tick “Add python.exe to PATH”

You do not need to start again. If you clicked **Install Now**, the setup still finds Python.

“Python 3.15 is not installed” even though you installed it

Restart the computer and run **Install.bat** again. If that does not help, open the Python installer again and choose **Repair**.

“Setup could not finish”

Check your internet connection and run **Install.bat** again.

“Stockfish could not be downloaded” or “it does not run”

Chessboard works without Stockfish, but the computer then only plays random moves. Run **Install.bat** again. If your antivirus program blocked or removed the file, allow **stockfish.exe** in its settings first. If the download keeps failing, follow “Installing Stockfish by hand” in the file **INSTALL.txt** in the Chessboard folder.

Only “Random moves” is offered as the opponent

Stockfish is not in place. Run **Install.bat** again and read the last message it shows.

“Chessboard is not set up yet”

Double-click **Install.bat** and let it finish, then start **Chessboard.bat** again.

Double-clicking Chessboard.bat does nothing

Look in the Chessboard folder for a file called **error.log**. If you ask someone for help, send them that file.